Xinyi Li

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, Spatial Economics, Firm Dynamics, Development Economics

EDUCATION

University of Notre Dame — Notre Dame, IN
Ph.D. in Economics — May 2027 (exp.)
M.A. in Economics — 2023

Central University of Finance and Economics (CUFE) — Beijing, China
M.S. in Finance — 2020
B.S. in Economics — 2017

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Land-Use Policy as Industrial Policy: Firm Selection, Spatial Misallocation, and Rural-Urban Redistribution" 2026

Abstract: This paper studies how the allocation of urban land to manufacturing affects productivity, output, and welfare through firm selection and rural-urban migration. Using detailed parcel-level land transactions and manufacturing firm survey data from China, I document that industrial land sells at a substantial discount relative to comparable residential land. Prefectures with larger discounts allocate a greater share of land to industrial use, have higher manufacturing employment shares, and sustain more manufacturing firms. Moreover, the composition of the manufacturing workforce and firms differs across prefectures. Rural migrants account for much of the associated manufacturing employment in these prefectures, while less productive firms make up a larger share of manufacturers. I develop a spatial equilibrium model with heterogeneous firms, rural-urban migration and land allocation between industrial and residential uses, and calibrate it to match these patterns. In the model, equalizing industrial and residential land prices within each prefecture reduces manufacturing output by 5.2% but raises average manufacturing productivity by about 7% through improved firm selection. Welfare rises by 2.3% for urban-origin workers, mainly driven by cheaper housing, and falls by 0.6% for rural-origin workers as demand for manufacturing labor declines. Reallocating industrial land towards prefectures where an additional unit of manufacturing output comes at a lower welfare cost can preserve aggregate manufacturing output at its baseline level while improving welfare for both urban- and rural-origin workers. These results highlight that the effects of land-based industrial policy depend on where production takes place, while firm selection and rural-urban migration shape who gains and who loses.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Energy Transitions and Their Distributional Impacts: 2005 and 2050" with Danchen Zhao

"How Free is Free Entry" with Dario Cardamone and Benjamin Pugsley

"Ripple Effects of Government Procurement: Market Response across Pharmaceutical Markets" with Yiren Ding

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Prof. Heitor S. Pellegrina, University of Notre Dame 2023–2025

Full-time Research Assistant to Prof. Yongmiao Hong, Xiamen University 2020–2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Principles of Microeconomics, University of Notre Dame	Fall and Summer 2026
Teaching Assistant, Statistics for Economics, University of Notre Dame	Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. Econometrics II, University of Notre Dame	Spring 2023
Teaching Assistant, Ph.D. Macroeconomics I, University of Notre Dame	Fall 2022
Teaching Assistant, Principles of Economics, CUFE	Spring 2020 and Fall 2019

AFFILIATIONS

Building Inclusive Growth (BIG) Lab, University of Notre Dame	2024–present
Kellogg Institute for International Studies, University of Notre Dame	2023–present

FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

Franco Family Institute Dissertation Fellowship	2026-2027
Kellogg Institute Conference Travel Grant	2025
BIG Lab Ph.D. Research Grant	2025
Kellogg Institute Professionalization Grant	2024

PRESENTATIONS

2026 Northeastern Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC)
Midwest Macroeconomics Meetings (scheduled)

2025 Southern Economic Association (SEA)

SKILLS

Programming: MATLAB, Stata, ArcGIS, Julia, LaTeX

Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

REFERENCES

Benjamin Pugsley (Chair)
Robert and Irene Bozzone Associate Professor
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